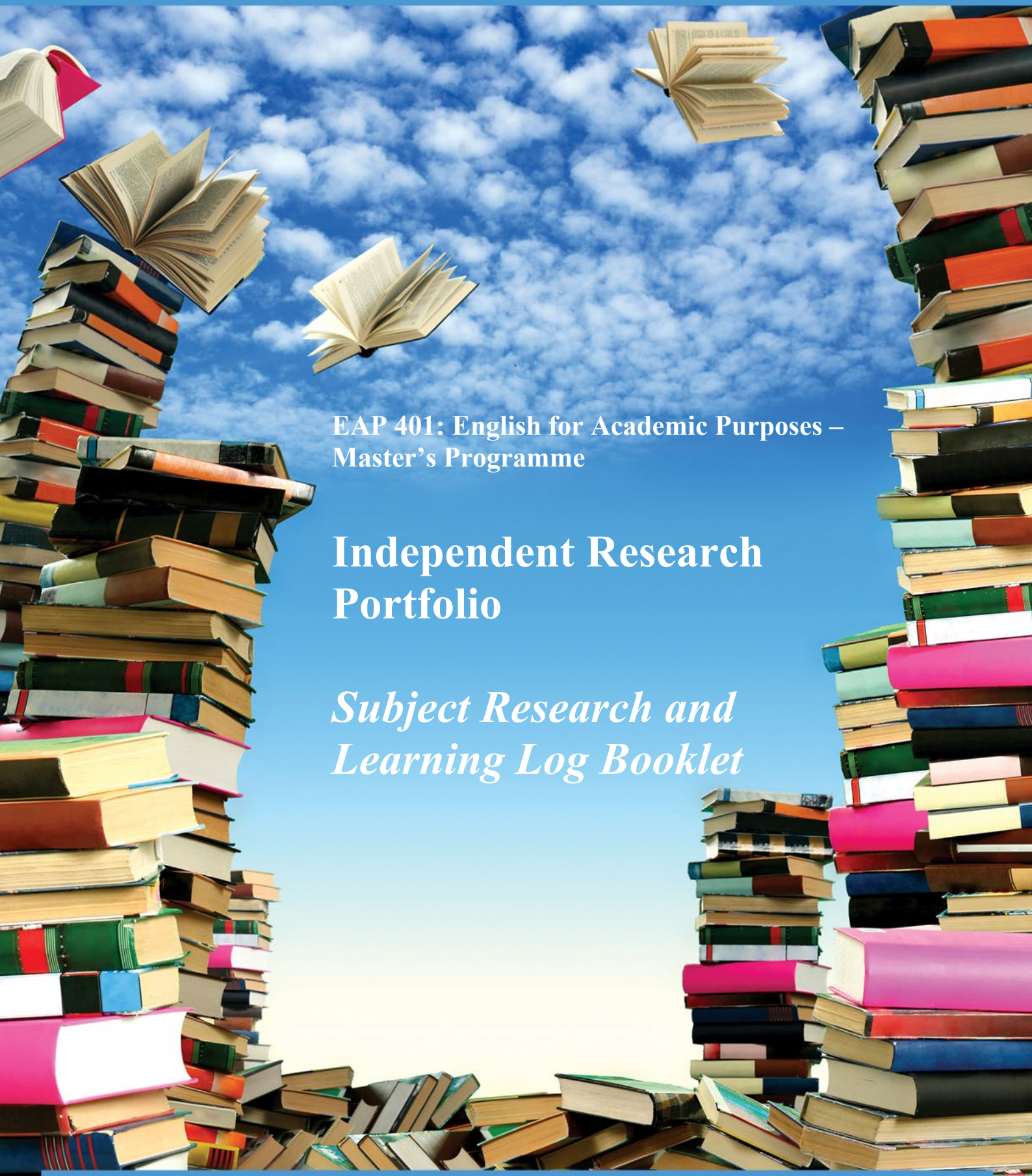
‘Life is really simple, but we insist on making it complicated.’

Confucius



EAP 401: English for Academic Purposes – Master’s Programme

Independent Research Portfolio

Subject Research and Learning Log Booklet

Name:

Student Number:

Class:

EAP 401 SELF-EVALUATION I

STUDY SKILLS: PRIORITIES, STAGE 1

Column A **Already have the skill?** Decide ✓ whether each statement is generally true of you.
Column B **Needed?** How important is it to you? Rate from 6 to 10. (6 = not needed. 10 = essential.)
Column C **Ability?** Rate how good you are at this skill now. (Scale 1 = very weak. 5 = excellent.)
Column D **Priority:** Subtract the score in column C from that in column B (B – C). Items with the highest scores in column D are likely to be priorities. Then turn to page 26. Repeat later in the year.

Study skills statements I have effective strategies for …	**A** This is true ✓	**B** Needed? (6–10)	**C** Ability? (1–5)	**D** Priority? (B–C)
1 organising myself well for study				
2 using my time effectively (Checklist, page 124)				
3 thinking creatively				
4 solving problems				
5 reading for academic purposes				
6 searching for information for assignments (Chapter 11)				
7 making, and using, good notes (Checklist, page 184)				
8 making best use of taught sessions (Evaluation, page 39)				
9 effective group and seminar work (Checklist, page 186)				
10 working collaboratively with others				
11 making presentations (Checklist, page 195)				
12 managing writing tasks (Checklist, page 274)				
13 writing essays using academic conventions				
14 writing reports and dissertations (Checklist, page 369)				
15 undertaking a research project (Checklist, pages 352–62)				
16 avoiding cheating/plagiarism				
17 citing sources and writing references				
18 improving my concentration				
19 thinking critically and analytically				
20 critiquing my own work and others' work				
21 managing stress, anxiety and well-being				
22 preparing for exams (Checklists, pp. 380, 383 and 387)				
23 evaluating and improving my work (Checklist, page 100)				
24 developing my memory for course material				

SELF-EVALUATION II

Column A Using the scoring from stage 1, decide whether each item really is a priority, whether it could wait, who else could do it, or any other options you have.

Column B Number your priorities in order. Highlight in yellow the one you are going to work on next. Highlight it in red once you have worked on it.

Study skills statements I will become more effective at …	**A:** Priority for action?	**B**	**C** pages
1 organising myself well for study			30–7
2 using my time effectively			123–50
3 thinking creatively			90–8
4 solving problems			93–8
5 reading for academic purposes			213–25
6 searching for information for assignments			233–44
7 making, and using, good notes			226–31
8 making best use of taught sessions			31–9
9 effective group and seminar work			175–86
10 working collaboratively with others			171–85
11 making presentations			189–95
12 managing writing tasks			273–300
13 writing essays using academic conventions			301–343
14 writing reports and dissertations			347–69
15 undertaking a research project			347–69
16 avoiding cheating/plagiarism			247–8
17 citing sources and writing references			249–51
18 improving my concentration			36; 84; 106; 141
19 thinking critically and analytically			253–72
20 critiquing my own work and others' work			266–72
21 managing stress, anxiety and well-being			151–68
22 preparing for exams			373–88
23 evaluating and improving my work			100; 315–17
24 developing my memory for course material			389–404

EAP 401 STUDY SKILLS ACTION PLAN TEMPLATE

Bring together your thoughts about your responses to activities, reflections and self-evaluations. Use these to develop an action plan to collate your thoughts and priorities for action.

Date:
Summary of my current strengths, skills and qualities: what I have achieved so far
Summary of what I need to work on, develop or improve
My priorities: what I am going to do, when, and how
How will I know that I have improved? (E.g. What changes would I expect in my work, in myself, or in the attitudes of others?)

IRP REFLECTIONS INSTRUCTION SHEET (from Week 2)

1. You will write fortnightly Reflections on your learning. Each of these should be at least 2 paragraphs in length (minimum 250 words in total) to reflect on your English language learning. This process will allow you to understand your strengths and weaknesses, and to improve your writing skills. If you are not sure about what you can include in your reflections, here are some questions to guide you:

- *What have you been doing in your classes? What thoughts and feelings do you have about classes?*
- *What have you been doing at home to improve your English? Were the results positive?*
- *What progress have you made since the previous week or two weeks?*
- *What problems have you encountered in your English learning? How did you solve them?*
- *What are your strengths and weaknesses? How can you use your strengths to the best of your ability? How can you improve your weaknesses?*
- *What are your objectives for next week(s)?*
- *What areas of writing/reading/listening/ do you feel you need to work on?*
- *What can you do to improve in these areas, either inside or outside the classroom?*

**NB Remember that thinking or reflecting on how you learn can improve the learning process.*

REFLECTIONS TEMPLATE: WEEK 2 REFLECTION

EAP 401 IRP SUBJECT RESEARCH (SR) INSTRUCTION SHEET (From Week 5)

Read steps 1-8 below. Having reviewed your Coursework Essay Task sheet:

1. Use the BJTU/LU library or another source to find a peer-reviewed/academic article which you consider useful for your essay.

2. Read the abstract (if there is one) to have an idea of the topic and how useful the article could be.

3. Make a note of the full reference details – record that information on the Article Evaluation form (see table on next pages):

4. Skim read the introduction and conclusion to get the general meaning.

5. Scan the whole article for specific information that you want to find.

6. Annotate the source text you have chosen by making notes in the margins and by highlighting or underlining key points. Add the annotated pages to the end of the Article Evaluation below. Copy and paste this to the Subject Research and Learning Log booklet and upload to Moodle before the deadline.

7. You should record unfamiliar words/phrases; there is a section at the bottom of the template to note down new vocabulary.

8. Evaluate the article by answering the question(s) in the evaluation form on the next pages.

EAP 401 IRP SUBJECT RESEARCH: ARTICLE EVALUATION 1/2/3/4:

Task: You are going to write a problem-solution essay on a topic in your own subject area.

You should examine a problem in your subject area and propose possible solutions. The solutions should then be evaluated (i.e. you should explain which solution (or solutions) is (or are) best and why. Any solutions should be supported by evidence.

Choose a source you plan to use in your essay. Read it carefully and answer the following **eight questions** in 2-4 sentences. Your answers will help you to better understand and critically engage with your source.

Name(s) of author(s)			
Full title of article			
Full title of Journal/Book/newspaper			
Year Published		*Month*	
Volume Number		*Issue Number*	
Link			
REFERENCE 🔗			

1. ***What is the main issue or problem addressed in this source?***
   Summarise the problem clearly. Is it technical, practical, environmental, economic, or social?

2. ***How does the source relate to the topic of your essay?***
   Explain how the issue discussed in the source connects to the problem you are analysing.

3. What causes or contributing factors are identified in the source?
Does the source offer a technical explanation for the problem? Are any data or case studies used to support this?

4. *Does the source propose any solutions or responses to the problem?*
Briefly describe any solutions, technologies, or strategies that are introduced or evaluated.

5. *What theoretical or engineering concepts are discussed in the source?*
Mention any key ideas, principles, or models (e.g. signal processing, system design, error control, sustainability, etc.). How do these relate to your essay?

6. *Is the source credible and technically reliable?* Who is the author or publisher? Is the source peer-reviewed or produced by a recognised institution?

7. *How might you use this source in your essay?*
Will it help you explain the problem, support your solution, or evaluate other possible approaches?

8. *What are the strengths or limitations of this source for your assignment?*
Consider the depth of analysis, clarity, technical accuracy, or potential bias.

VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT

Record at least 5 unfamiliar vocabulary or phrases that you encountered in the article; you should include any terms you may need to define in the essay. When you give an example in context, do not use the context from the journal article. Please include all the elements (a-e) in the example below:

Example:

1. Word: Explicit (adj.) /ɪkˈsplɪsɪt/
   - **a)** *Definition in English*: clear and easy to understand
   - **b)** *Word family*: explicitly (adv.): explicitness (n.)
   - **c)** *Collocations*: make / render explicit, fairly explicit
   - **d)** *Example in a sentence:* 'Darwin did not at first make explicit his view that human beings are descended from apelike ancestors.'
   - **e)** *Synonyms:* clear, obvious, straightforward, direct

2. ……

   - **a)** .... *etc*